# PART I: WRITTEN RECEPTION (70 points)

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Time: 75 minutes. Answer in English. No dictionary. Total: 100 points.

Read the article and answer questions 1-9. Line numbers refer to this page.

## A BANK THAT USES TIME

**I** People usually pay money when they need someone to repair a chair or teach them a new skill. However, residents of the town of Brookfield have another option. They can join a "time bank," a program in which people exchange help without using money. Members earn one time credit for every hour they spend helping someone. They can then use their credits to receive help from other members. The program aims to bring neighbors together by giving everyone an opportunity to contribute.

**II** To join, residents complete a form describing the skills they can offer and the help they need. A coordinator uses this information to connect members. An hour of gardening earns the same credit as an hour of computer lessons, even if one of these services usually costs more. Members do not have to help the person who helped them. For example, someone who repairs a bicycle can use the credit to get cooking lessons from a different member.

**III** When the program began, fewer people joined than the organizers had expected. At first, the organizers thought residents were too busy to take part. However, conversations with local people revealed a different problem: many believed they had nothing useful to offer. In response, the organizers held meetings where they gave examples of simple tasks, such as watering plants while a neighbor was away. More residents joined after they realized that professional training was not necessary.

**IV** One of the new members was sixteen-year-old Adam, who helped an older resident organize photographs on her phone. Later, he used his credits to receive help preparing for a job interview from another member, a retired manager. Adam had originally joined to gain practical experience, but he discovered an additional benefit. Before joining, he rarely spoke to the adults on his street. Now, he feels more comfortable asking them for advice, and several have asked him for help with their phones.

**V** The time bank still faces difficulties. Some requests remain unanswered because nobody with the right skills is available. In addition, members sometimes cancel arrangements at the last minute, leaving others without the help they expected. The organizers are considering a reminder system, but they have not introduced it yet. Although the program cannot replace every paid service, they believe it offers something valuable: a chance for people to recognize abilities in themselves and in their neighbors.

# QUESTIONS (70 points)

Glossary: time credit = a unit recorded for an hour of help;
coordinator = someone who organizes a group; retired = no longer working because of age.

Answer according to the article. Circle ONE answer in questions 1, 2, 4 and 9.
For the other questions, follow the instructions.

### 1. What do we learn about time credits in paragraph I? (lines 1-7)

i) Members receive them for helping other people.

ii) Members buy them when they join the program.

iii) Members can use them only for professional services.

iv) Members receive them only from the people they have helped.

(8 points)

### 2. What is true about an hour of gardening and an hour of computer lessons? (lines 8-13)

i) Their usual prices must be the same.

ii) They earn the same number of time credits.

iii) They must be offered by the same member.

iv) Their time credits depend on their usual prices.

(7 points)

### 3. What does "this information" (line 9) refer to? (lines 8-9)

**Give TWO details.**

_____

_____

(8 points)

### 4. Why did many residents hesitate to join the program? (lines 14-17)

i) They thought they were too busy to take part.

ii) They did not want to speak to the organizers.

iii) They believed they had no useful skills to offer.

iv) They preferred to pay for professional services.

(8 points)

# QUESTIONS (70 points)

Answer according to the article. Circle ONE answer in questions 1, 2, 4 and 9.
For the other questions, follow the instructions.

### 5. Why did more residents join after the meetings? (lines 17-20)

**COMPLETE THE SENTENCE.**

They realized that they did not need

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(8 points)

### 6. Why did Adam originally join the time bank? (lines 21-25)

**COMPLETE THE SENTENCE.**

He wanted to

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(8 points)

### 7. Who does "them" (line 26) refer to? (lines 25-27)

**ANSWER THE QUESTION.**

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(8 points)

### 8. Why can the reminder system not help members yet? (lines 28-32)

**COMPLETE THE SENTENCE.**

Because the organizers

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(7 points)

### 9. Which statement best expresses the main message of the article? (lines 1-34)

i) A time bank succeeds only when it attracts trained professionals.

ii) A time bank allows communities to stop using paid services.

iii) A time bank solves the problem of finding help for every member.

iv) A time bank can connect neighbors even though it has limitations.

(8 points)

# PART II: LEXICAL KNOWLEDGE (30 points)

Vocabulary focus: Band III Core I - List A.

In each question, match three of the items 1-6 to the definitions on the right.
Write the item number on each line. Use each item only once in each question.
There are three extra items in every question. Each correct match is worth 2 points.

### (10)

1. objective
2. consequence
3. guidance
4. request
5. proof
6. priority

____ advice that helps you decide what to do

____ something that happens because of an action or event

____ information showing that something is true

### (11)

1. participate
2. prevent
3. recommend
4. investigate
5. generate
6. rely on

____ to examine something carefully to find out what happened

____ to stop something from happening

____ to suggest that something is a good choice

### (12)

1. efficient
2. flexible
3. reliable
4. limited
5. relevant
6. significant

____ able to change to suit a new situation

____ able to be trusted to do what is expected

____ connected with the subject being discussed

### (13)

1. deliberately
2. essentially
3. hopefully
4. naturally
5. seldom
6. unfortunately

____ on purpose rather than by accident

____ not very often

____ used to say that a situation is disappointing or unlucky

### (14)

1. at least
2. even though
3. in the meantime
4. run out of
5. take advantage of
6. be responsible for

____ to use all of something so that none is left

____ to have a duty to deal with something

____ during the time before another event happens